



Visual art S/H Review Guide

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Range: Unit 1-Unit 7

Note: (Review Guide/Review Practices/Practice Set) are UNOFFICIAL sources of reference and do NOT include or hint at questions in the actual exam!

Unit 1: Line & Texture

LINE

A mark or stroke made (with pen, pencil, paint, etc.) to show movement, an object's placement, or to communicate a visual feeling.

✓ Depending on the way line is used in a composition, the artist has the ability to use line to communicate a specific emotion:

◆ **Vertical Line:** Stability/Structure/Power

◆ **Horizontal Line:** Rest/Relaxation/Calmness

◆ **Curving Line:** Movement/Sporadic/Energy

◆ **Diagonal Line:** Unbalanced/Chaotic

◆ **Contour (Line):** The outline; the edge or line that defines or bounds a shape or object.

✓ Objects would not be visible to the human eye without a contour:²

In a 2 dimensional drawing/painting, the contour lines can be considered the object(s) outline.²

In a real (3 dimensional) object, the contour is simply the line that defines its edges.² Implied Line: Line that doesn't physically exist but is implied to exist

TEXTURE

A visual characteristic of the relationship between the way an object looks and feels (by touch).

✓ Visual texture is used in art to also communicate an idea or emotion.

COMPOSITION

A visual characteristic of the relationship between the way an object looks and feels.

OVERLAP

When an object(s) covers or partially covers another object in a composition to convey the idea of space.

✓ Overlapping helps to communicate depth and a sense of real space in a composition.

REPETITION

When something is repeated or occurs over and over again in the same composition.

✓ Using repetition within a composition helps to give the composition unity and consistency.

◆ *Edgar Degas*: A French artist famous for his paintings, sculptures, prints, and drawings.

◆ *Andy Warhol*: An American artist, director, and producer who was a leading figure in the visual art movement known as pop art.

◆ *Henri Matisse*: A French artist, known for his use of color and his fluid and original draughtsmanship. A draughtsman, printmaker, and sculptor, but is known primarily as a painter.

Unit 2: Color & Value

COLOR (HUE)

The amount of light reflected on an object.

✓ The only way the color of an object can be seen depends on the amount of light reflected on its surface

1. Primary Colors: Natural/basic colors that can't be created with the combination of other colors.

2. Secondary Colors: The combination of two primary colors.

3. Tertiary Colors: The combination of a primary color and a secondary color.

VALUE (TINT, TONE, & SHADE)

The degree of lightness or darkness within a given color, shade, tone or tint.

✓ Changing a color's value usually makes the color seem less intense or subtle.

◆ **Shade:** Black; the value of a color becomes darker depending on the degree of shade used with that color.

◆ **Tone:** Grey; the value of a color becomes grayer depending on the degree of tone used with that color.

◆ **Tint:** White; the value of a color becomes lighter depending on the degree of tint used with that color.

◆ ***Monochromatic*** (单色模式)²

The use of a wide range of tints and shades of a single color. **Harmonious & Subtle**

◆ ***Complementary*** (互补色模式)²

The use of opposite colors on the color wheel.

Very Vibrant

◆ ***Analogous*** (相似色模式)²

The use of a set of colors that are adjacent to each other on the color wheel.²

Harmonious & Subtle

◆ ***Split Complementary*** (补色分割模式)²

The combination of complementary and analogous schemes that allows intensity but is not as strong as pure complementary.²

Vibrant & Harmonious

◆ *Triadic (三等分配色模式)*²

The use of three colors equally spaced around the color wheel.² Vibrant & Harmonious

BALANCE

Arranging elements in a composition so that no one part of a work overpowers, or seem sheavier than any other part.

✓ Balance is a principle of design that deals with the visual weight within a composition.

◆ Symmetrical²

A balance that shows stability, usually centered in the composition.

◆ Vertical²

A type of symmetrical balance that shows a vertical orientation.

◆ Horizontal²

A type of symmetrical balance that shows a horizontal orientation.

◆ Asymmetrical²

A balance that is not centered and not symmetrical.

◆ Radial²

A type of balance where all the elements of an object expand or spiral out from a central point.

FOCAL POINT

The focus or most important visual part within a composition.

✓ The basic elements and principles can help determine a composition's focal point(E.g. the way the implied line is used, color/value intensity, contrast, etc.)

CONTRAST

The difference or opposites of two objects, elements, etc.

✓ Contrast is a principle of design that is the arrangement of opposite elements (e.g. light vs. dark colors, rough vs. smooth textures, large vs. small shapes, etc.) in a piece to create visual interest.

INTENSITY

The strength or sharpness of a color due to its degree of freedom from mixture with its complement.

✓ A color's intensity can be seen at its purest form or when not mixed with any other color, shade, tone, or tint.

✓ Other factors also play into a color's intensity. E.g. value change around a specific color, texture around a given color, etc.

Unit 3: Element and Principles

SHAPE

A two-dimensional area that is created when a line or contour is closed, when there is a change in value, or some other form of contrast

Shapes help to create: complex drawings and paintings so affect composition or contribute to the balance within a work- All shapes are two-dimensional, meaning that they have only length and width

Tessellation: an arrangement of shapes closely fitted together, especially of polygons in a repeated pattern without gaps or overlapping

Geometric (shape): shapes that are usually recognizable by name- Math can be used to find information about these shapes- Eg: circle, square, trapezoid, etc

Organic (shape): shapes that seem to follow no rules

FORM: an element of art that is similar to shape but with the added dimension of depth

MOVEMENT

A principle of design that uses any element to show an energy, flow, or a feeling that objects within a given composition are in motion

PATTERN

Showing consistency with colors, lines, values, textures, etc. throughout a composition

Unit 4: Inner Space and Perspective

SPACE

The visual element that refers to the area between, around, above, below, and within objects

- *Gives artwork its dimension and helps to communicate dynamic composition*
- Sometimes isn't actually within a piece, but the illusion of it is

NEGATIVE SPACE

Space surrounding shapes or forms in two- and three-dimensional art

- As a balance to positive space
- Often overlooked
- Gives the eye a "place to rest", increasing the appeal of a composition through subtle means

POSITIVE SPACE

Area or part of a painting's composition that the subject occupies

- The composition's actual subject matter (the main focus of a work)
- *Positive space: specific elements render detail to catch the viewer's eye & should work equally with negative space*

PROPORTION

A principle of art that describes the size, location, or amount of one element to another (or to the whole) in a work

- The relationship between the size of figures and objects within a composition
- E.g.: The size of an arm in relation to the rest of the body, the size of a person in relation to the size of a house

FORESHORTENING

A method of rendering a specific object or figure in depth. The artist records distortion that is seen by the eye when an object or figure is viewed at a distance or unusual angle

PERSPECTIVE

Developed in the 15th century by the architects Leon Baptista Alberti (1404-72) and Filippo Brunelleschi (1377-1446)- Remained one of the basic principles of Western art until it was challenged by the ideas of the Cubists at the start of the 20th century

Linear Perspective- Deals with the organization of shapes in space

Atmospheric/Aerial Perspective- Deals with the atmospheric effects on tones and colors

ONE POINT PERSPECTIVE

The Perspective of a Rectangle/Box

- It uses a single vanishing point to draw an object- Simplist form of perspective drawing
- The front and back transversal planes always remain parallel to the picture plane
- Only their scale changes as an object recedes into the distance- Only the receding orthogonal lines change angles

There are two types of construction lines used in perspective drawing

TWO POINT PERSPECTIVE

- Used in illustrations of objects which have been rotated at an angle to the picture plane
- Uses two sets of orthogonal lines and two vanishing points to draw each object
- No longer any planes parallel to the picture plane

Unit 5

Vocab

Fresco: plaster wall paintings

Contrapposto: counterpose, used to describe a body gesture where one leg is in front of the other

Columns: A post or structure used to support an architecture

Arch: a curved architectural element used to span an opening

Mosaics: The use of small colored objects to form a larger image

Diptych: 2 panels of art work that is hinged together

Rotunda: architecture with a round structure & a dome at the top

Icon: religious symbol

Triptych: 3 panels of art work that is hinged together

Illumination: colored illustrations containing gold and silver

Cathedral: a large Romanesque or Gothic style church that houses the chair(cathedra) of the Bishop

Cruciform: any design in the shape of a cross

Flying Buttress: "flying" arches combined with tower buttresses

Vault: The use of the Roman arch with a depth added to it

Patron: a person who supports the arts

Isocephaly: arranging the heads of figures at the same level

Tempera: a water-based pigment mixed with egg yolk

Chiaroscuro: extreme contrast of dark and light values

Realism: attention to extreme detail

Symbolism: the use of an object to represent a meaning other than its own outward appearance

Printmaking: the art of using different techniques to make prints

Polyptych: painting with more than 3 panels hinged together

Chateaux: a French castle or large country house

Tenebrism: exaggerated contrast of darks & lights

Camera Obscura: a dark box/room with a small opening to let light in

Rococo: late Baroque style that is described as pretty or overdone

Unit 7

Neoclassicism: (literally means "the New Classic Period")

Napoleon's interest in the Classic Greek and Roman periods resulted in his idea

to “relive” those periods.

Allegorical: (Symbols that tell a story, a symbolic narrative)

Most of David's both told a story (mostly historical) and had some type of symbolic meaning or parallel to what was going on in modern day France.

Romanticism: (A movement with a revival of interesting Medieval stories and the emotion of artistic elements)

Nonobjective: (Art that has no recognizable subject matter, only the use of raw elements)

Some artists in Romantic art used nonrepresentational subject matter to communicate the motion of an idea.

Realist: (A term used to describe an artist that painted in the Realist movement)

The Realists emphasize the depiction of the common, everyday world

Photography: (The art of producing images on photosensitive (light sensitive) paper)

This technology came from the idea of printmaking and how an image can be made by first creating a mold or stencil.

Impressionism: (A style of painting that emphasizes momentary effects of light on color)

Artists seek to create an instant impression, not a detailed analysis.

Pointillism: (colors that are systematically applied to canvas with small dots)

Today, we see a similar technique in TV screens, computers, and color printing.

Expressionism: (the communication of strong personal and emotional feelings in artwork)

Van Gogh was considered the artist that began this art movement.

Primitivism: (less sophisticated native art of any culture)

Gauguin moved to Tahiti because he became interested in a much more

primitive lifestyle.